

Software Requirements Specification (SRS)



A Private University Social Network Platform

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Course: System Analysis and Design

Institution: United International University (UIU), Dhaka

Submission Date: 17 June 2026

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1. Introduction

1.1 Project Overview

UniConnecT is a multi-tenant private social networking platform designed exclusively for university communities, connecting students, alumni, faculty, and administrative staff within a shared, institution-specific digital environment. Unlike general-purpose social networks, UniConnecT scopes all interactions, content, and connections to a single university per deployment, ensuring every engagement is relevant, verified, and community-driven. The platform serves as a central hub for academic and professional campus life, bringing together social engagement, career opportunities, mentorship, campus services, and real-time communication under one cohesive interface.

1.2 Purpose of the System

The purpose of UniConnecT is to eliminate the fragmentation that currently exists across university communication channels by providing one cohesive platform where every member of the university community can connect, collaborate, and grow. Through UniConnecT, students can build their professional network, discover job and internship opportunities, receive structured mentorship from alumni, stay informed through official university news, join groups and clubs, and coordinate campus activities — all within a verified, institution-bound environment. Faculty and administrators gain a structured channel to publish announcements, manage users and content, and engage with the broader campus community. Transport staff can broadcast live shuttle location data for student use.

1.3 Problem Statement / Motivation

University communities currently lack a dedicated digital space that serves their unique social and professional needs. Students rely on a fragmented combination of general social media platforms, university email chains, physical notice boards, and third-party job portals — none of which are tailored to the university context or integrated with one another. This fragmentation results in missed job and internship opportunities, weak alumni-to-student mentorship pipelines, poor information flow between administration and students, and no unified sense of campus identity online. Beyond social and professional concerns, practical campus services such as lost-and-found coordination and shuttle tracking are handled through informal channels with no digital structure. UniConnecT is proposed to address all of these challenges by offering a modern, purpose-built platform that brings the entire university experience — social, professional, academic, and logistical — into a single, well-designed digital space.

2. Project Objectives

The primary objectives of UniConnecT are as follows:

- **Unified Campus Social Feed:** Provide a community-driven social feed where students, alumni, and faculty can post, react, comment on, and share content relevant to their university.
- **Alumni–Student Mentorship:** Design a structured mentorship module enabling students to discover alumni mentors and request guidance on academic and career development.
- **Job and Internship Discovery:** Offer a university-internal job board where alumni and faculty can post opportunities and students can browse and apply, all within a trusted institutional network.
- **Campus Events Management:** Enable creation, browsing, and RSVP for campus events so the community stays informed and engaged in university life.
- **Professional Connection Network:** Implement a bidirectional LinkedIn-style connection system allowing members to build and grow a verified university professional network.
- **Groups and Clubs:** Support the creation and management of university groups (clubs, departments, study circles) with dedicated feeds, file resources, study sessions, member roles, and group rules.
- **Real-Time Messaging:** Provide direct and group messaging for communication between connected community members and within mentorship relationships.
- **Campus Utilities:** Integrate practical campus tools — a lost-and-found item tracking module and a real-time shuttle schedule and location tracker — directly into the platform.
- **Role-Based Access and Multi-Tenancy:** Design distinct, role-aware interface views for students, alumni, faculty, administrators, and transport drivers, with each university operating as a fully isolated tenant.
- **Modern, Accessible, Responsive Interface:** Deliver a visually consistent, accessible UI across desktop, tablet, and mobile screen sizes, built on a unified UIU-branded design system.

3. Target Users

The following user groups are the intended audience for UniConnecT. All users belong to a single university community; the platform does not allow cross-university interaction.

- **Students:** The primary users of the platform. Students use UniConnecT to browse and post on the social feed, build connections with peers and alumni, discover jobs and internships, join groups and clubs, RSVP for events, request mentorship from alumni, access campus news, save drafts, report lost items, and track shuttle locations.
- **Alumni:** Graduated members of the university who maintain access to the platform after leaving. Alumni can post job and internship opportunities, offer mentorship to current students, engage with the social feed, participate in groups, and stay professionally connected to the university community.
- **Faculty:** Academic staff members who use the platform to publish announcements and news, engage with students and alumni, create and manage events, and participate in group discussions. Faculty may also act in a moderation capacity within their department-level groups.
- **System Administrators:** University administrators who oversee the platform's operation. Administrators manage user accounts and roles, issue and revoke invitation tokens, moderate reported content, configure university-wide settings, and monitor platform activity through a dedicated admin panel. All administrative actions are recorded in an audit log.
- **Transport Driver:** A least-privilege role assigned exclusively to campus shuttle and transport staff. Drivers interact only with a dedicated GPS broadcast view to transmit live shuttle location data to the platform. They have no access to the broader social application.

4. Functional Requirements

The functional requirements define the specific behaviors and capabilities the UniConnecT system shall provide. Each requirement is labeled with a unique identifier for traceability.

FR-1: The system shall allow new users to register using a valid university invitation token, providing their full name, email address, and a chosen password.

FR-2: The system shall send a one-time password (OTP) to the user's registered email

address upon registration, which must be confirmed to activate the account.

- FR-3:** The system shall allow registered users to log in with their email and password and log out securely from any session.
- FR-4:** The system shall support a password recovery flow that allows users to request a reset link via their registered university email address.
- FR-5:** The system shall validate all user input during registration and login, displaying clear inline error messages for missing or invalid fields.
- FR-6:** The system shall display a personalized social feed upon login, showing posts, reactions, and activity from the user’s university community, sortable by “Recent” and “Top” (engagement-ranked) modes.
- FR-7:** The system shall allow users to create, edit, delete, and save draft posts on the social feed, with support for text content, images, and links.
- FR-8:** The system shall allow users to react to and comment on any post in the feed, with real-time count updates.
- FR-9:** The system shall allow users to view and edit their own profile, including profile photo, bio, work experience entries, education history, skills, and featured items (maximum five).
- FR-10:** The system shall track profile views and provide each profile owner with an analytics view showing visitor counts over the past 7, 30, and 90 days, along with a list of recent viewers.
- FR-11:** The system shall allow users to send, accept, decline, and withdraw connection requests. Accepted connections form a persistent, bidirectional professional network visible on each user’s profile.
- FR-12:** The system shall display connection suggestions to users based on mutual connections and shared university affiliation.
- FR-13:** The system shall provide a unified full-text search interface through which users can search for people, posts, jobs, events, groups, and news by keyword, with filterable result tabs per content type.
- FR-14:** The system shall allow alumni and faculty to post job and internship listings specifying role title, description, requirements, and application deadline.
- FR-15:** The system shall display job listings in a filterable, sortable list view, with a detail page for each listing.

- FR-16:** The system shall allow users to create and browse campus events, with RSVP functionality and a detail view showing date, location, description, and confirmed attendee count.
- FR-17:** The system shall allow users to create, join, and leave groups (clubs, departments, study circles), with public and private group types. Private groups require a join request approved by a group administrator.
- FR-18:** The system shall allow group administrators to manage member roles (admin, moderator, member), pin posts, post group rules, share file resources with view tracking, and schedule study sessions with RSVP.
- FR-19:** The system shall provide real-time direct messaging between any two connected users, and group messaging within shared conversation threads.
- FR-20:** The system shall automatically create a dedicated conversation thread for each accepted mentorship request, linking the student and the alumni mentor within the messaging module.
- FR-21:** The system shall deliver real-time in-app notifications for events including new connection requests, accepted connections, new messages, post reactions, mentions, event updates, and mentorship activity.
- FR-22:** The system shall allow students to send mentorship requests to alumni, specifying their goals and area of guidance sought. Alumni may accept or decline requests subject to their configured maximum mentee capacity.
- FR-23:** The system shall allow users to browse and read official university news and announcements published by faculty or administrators, with a detail page per article.
- FR-24:** The system shall provide a lost-and-found module where users can post reports of lost or found campus items, including a description, location, and optional photo.
- FR-25:** The system shall display campus shuttle route schedules and real-time shuttle location, updated continuously from driver GPS broadcasts.
- FR-26:** The system shall allow drivers (driver role exclusively) to broadcast their GPS location via a dedicated interface, which is reflected live on the student-facing shuttle tracker.
- FR-27:** The system shall provide an administrator panel through which admins can manage user accounts, assign and change roles, create and revoke invitation tokens

(including bulk invitations), resolve content reports, and configure university-wide settings.

FR-28: The system shall aggregate all of a user's unpublished drafts — across posts, job listings, news articles, and events — into a single drafts view accessible only by the author.

FR-29: The system shall allow users to configure notification preferences, privacy settings (profile visibility, presence visibility, message accessibility), and application appearance (light or dark theme) from a dedicated settings hub.

5. Non-Functional Requirements

Non-functional requirements specify the quality attributes and operational constraints the UniConnecT design shall satisfy.

NFR-1: Usability: The interface shall be intuitive and learnable, enabling a new student user to complete primary tasks — registration, OTP verification, profile setup, browsing the feed, and sending a connection request — without external documentation or guidance.

NFR-2: Consistency: All pages shall adhere to the UniConnecT design system, maintaining a consistent color palette, typography (font weight restricted to 400 and 500), spacing scale, border style (0.5px structural borders), and component visual language throughout. No hardcoded color values shall appear outside the defined token set.

NFR-3: Responsiveness: The interface shall render correctly and remain fully usable across three primary breakpoints: mobile (360px–767px), tablet (768px–1023px), and desktop (1024px and above). Navigation shall collapse to a bottom tab bar on mobile; multi-column layouts shall reflow to single-column views.

NFR-4: Performance (Perceived): The feed, dashboard, profile, and listing pages shall use skeleton loading states during data load, ensuring the interface appears immediately responsive and never presents a blank screen to the user.

NFR-5: Accessibility: All text-on-background color combinations in both the dark and light themes shall meet a minimum 4.5:1 contrast ratio (WCAG 2.1 Level AA). All interactive elements shall carry visible focus states. All form inputs shall have descriptive labels; icon-only controls shall include tooltips.

NFR-6: Feedback and Error Handling: The design shall include explicit visual states for every user action: button hover, loading, success, and error. Inline

validation errors shall appear adjacent to the failing field. All list and feed views shall have a designed empty state rather than a blank area.

NFR-7: Role-Based Interface Separation: The design shall strictly enforce role-aware navigation and page access. The admin panel shall not surface in navigation for non-admin roles. The driver GPS broadcast view shall be accessible only to driver-role users. Students, alumni, and faculty shall each see a navigation set scoped to their role's permitted features.

NFR-8: Dual-Theme Support: The design system shall define both a *Warm Futuristic Dark* default theme (navy surfaces, UIU orange accent, indigo interactive states) and a *Warm Neutral Light* theme. All components shall be designed to render correctly in both themes without design-level modifications per page.

NFR-9: Modifiability: The Figma design system shall use shared component libraries (atoms and molecules) so that any design system change — color, typography, spacing, border radius — propagates consistently across all pages without requiring individual page edits.

NFR-10: Readability: Body text shall be set at a minimum of 14px with adequate line-height. Section headings shall establish hierarchy through size and weight differences alone, not color. All UI labels and button text shall use sentence case; no ALL CAPS labels shall appear anywhere in the interface.

6. Pages / Modules

The following pages and modules constitute the UniConnecT Figma prototype. Each entry represents a distinct screen or logical section of the planned application.

1. **Landing Page** — The public entry point of UniConnecT, presenting the platform's value proposition with a hero section and calls to action ("Join Your University Network", "Log In").
2. **Registration Page** — An invitation-token-gated sign-up form collecting the user's full name, email address, and password.
3. **OTP Verification Page** — A code-entry screen for confirming the user's email address using the one-time password sent upon registration.
4. **Login Page** — A secure sign-in form for registered users with inline validation and a "Forgot Password" link.
5. **Forgot Password / Reset Password Page** — A two-step recovery flow: the

user submits their email, then follows a link to set a new password.

6. **Social Feed (Home / Dashboard)** — The primary authenticated screen displaying a ranked, scrollable feed of community posts, with “Recent” and “Top” sort tabs, a left-side profile summary panel, and a right-side discovery sidebar.
7. **Post Detail Page** — A full-page view of a single post showing the complete content, all reactions, and a threaded comment section.
8. **Profile Page** — Displays a user’s public profile: cover photo, avatar, bio, experience, education, skills, featured items, recent activity, and profile analytics. Includes an edit flow for the profile owner.
9. **Connections / My Network Page** — Shows the user’s accepted connections, incoming pending requests, sent requests, and a “People You May Know” suggestions section.
10. **Explore Page** — A discovery screen for finding new community members, trending content, and activity outside the user’s immediate connection network.
11. **Search Results Page** — A unified results screen with filterable tabs for People, Posts, Jobs, Events, Groups, and News.
12. **Jobs Page** — A filterable, sortable listing of job and internship postings within the university network, with a detail page per listing and a posting form for eligible users.
13. **Events Page** — A listing of upcoming campus events with RSVP functionality and a full detail view per event.
14. **Groups Page** — A directory of university groups and clubs, with a detail view per group showing the group feed, members list, file resources, scheduled study sessions, pinned posts, and group rules.
15. **Messages Page** — A real-time messaging interface with a conversation list sidebar and an active chat panel, supporting direct and group conversations as well as dedicated mentorship threads.
16. **Notifications Page** — A chronological list of all in-app notifications for the logged-in user, covering connections, messages, reactions, mentions, and mentorship activity.
17. **News Page** — A listing of official university news and announcements, with a detail view per article including title, body, and publication date.

18. **Mentorship Page** — A module where students browse alumni mentor profiles and submit mentorship requests, and where alumni manage their active mentees, session records, and mentee capacity.
19. **Lost & Found Page** — A campus utility module for posting and browsing reports of lost or found items, with descriptions, last-known location, and optional photo.
20. **Shuttle Tracker Page** — Displays campus shuttle route schedules and a live shuttle position map updated from driver GPS broadcasts.
21. **Driver GPS Broadcast View** — A minimal, role-restricted interface for transport drivers to broadcast their current GPS location to the platform.
22. **Drafts Page** — A personal page aggregating all of the user's unpublished drafts across posts, job listings, news articles, and events.
23. **Settings Page** — A multi-section hub covering appearance (light / dark theme), account management (deactivation, username), notification preferences, and privacy controls (profile, presence, and message visibility).
24. **Admin Panel** — A role-restricted management interface for administrators covering user management, role assignment, invitation management (individual and bulk), content report resolution, platform statistics, and university configuration.

7. Tools and Technologies

This section covers the design and prototyping tools used for UniConnecT. It describes the design process only.

- **Figma** — Primary tool for all UI/UX work: wireframing, high-fidelity mockups, interactive prototyping, and the shared component design system. All 24 pages and user flows are designed within Figma.
- **Figma Plugins:**
 - *Iconify* — Used to source and insert scalable vector icons (Phosphor Icons and Heroicons sets) directly into Figma frames.
 - *Unsplash* — Used to insert high-quality placeholder photography for profile avatars, event covers, and news thumbnails within mockups.
 - *A11y — Color Contrast Checker* — Used to verify that all text and UI element color pairings meet WCAG 2.1 Level AA contrast requirements across both dark and light themes.

- *Lorem Ipsum* — Used to generate placeholder body text for feed posts, news articles, and job descriptions during wireframing.
- **FigJam** — Used to create the navigation flow diagram and module architecture diagram, leveraging FigJam’s drag-and-drop connector tools and sticky-note layout for clear, readable system diagrams.
- **Canva** — Used for supplementary graphics including the project cover slide, presentation visuals, and promotional design assets.
- **Google Fonts** — Typography selections (Inter for UI labels and body text) sourced from Google Fonts and applied within the Figma design system.
- **Coolors** — Used to explore and finalize the UniConnecT color palette for both the Warm Futuristic Dark theme (navy, UIU orange, indigo) and the Warm Neutral Light theme.

8. System Design / Wireframe

All visuals in this section are taken from the Figma design prototype. The figures below present wireframes and UI sketches for the major pages of UniConnecT, along with a navigation flow diagram and module architecture diagram.

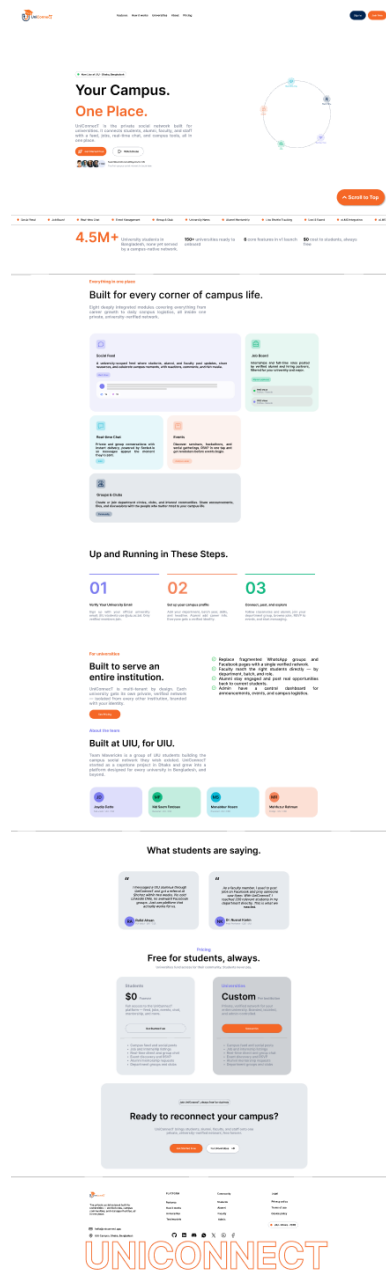


Figure 1: Figma Wireframe — Landing Page. The public entry screen with a hero section presenting UniConnecT's value proposition, a top navigation bar, and calls to action for new and returning users.

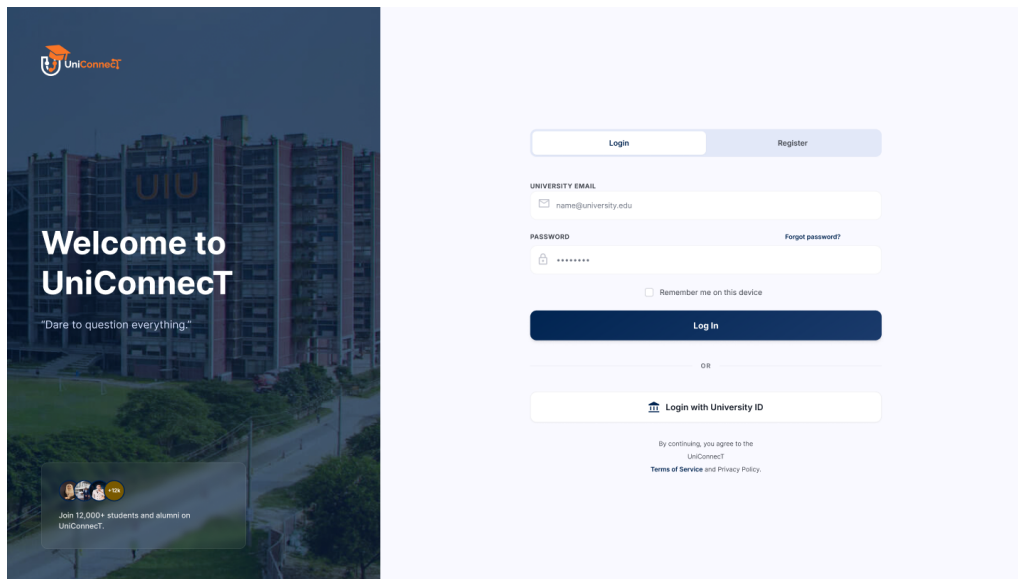


Figure 2: Figma Wireframe — Login Page. Email and password input form with inline validation states, a “Forgot Password” link, and the university domain context displayed in the header.

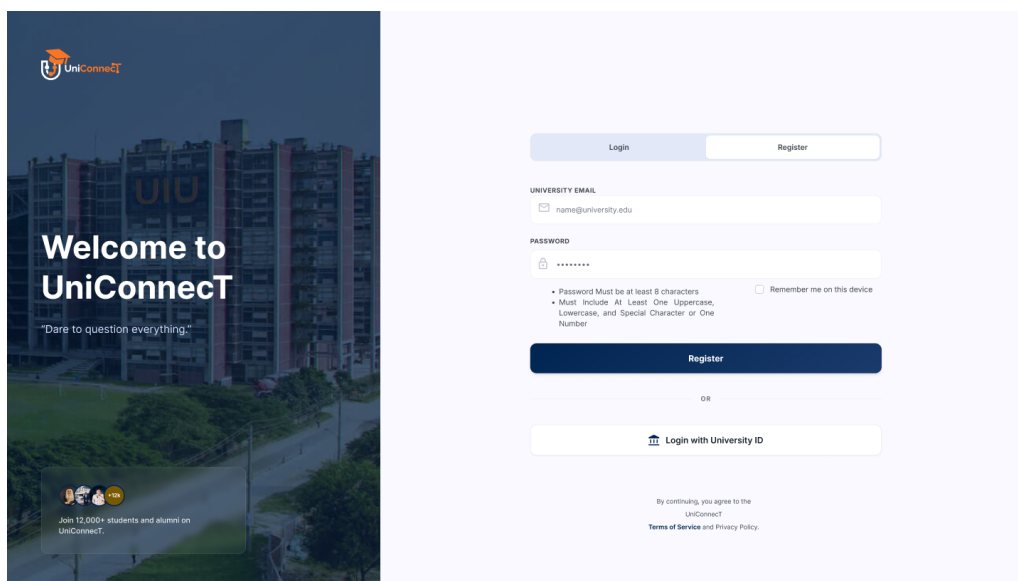


Figure 3: Figma Wireframe — Registration Page. Invitation-token-gated sign-up form collecting name, email, and password, followed by the OTP email verification step.

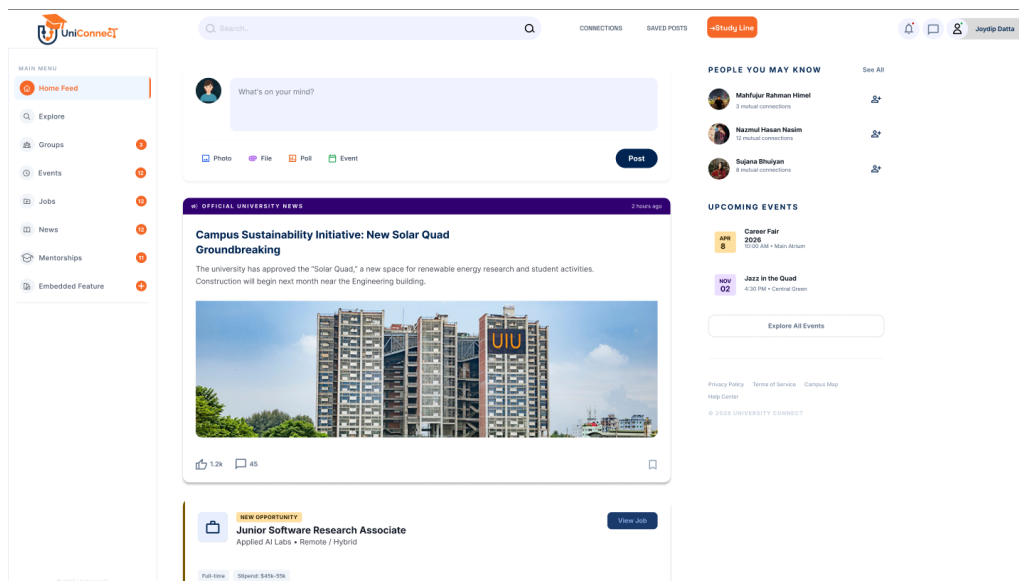


Figure 4: Figma Wireframe — Social Feed (Dashboard). The main authenticated screen: ranked post feed in the centre, a profile summary panel on the left, and a discovery/suggestions sidebar on the right. “Recent” and “Top” feed tabs are shown.

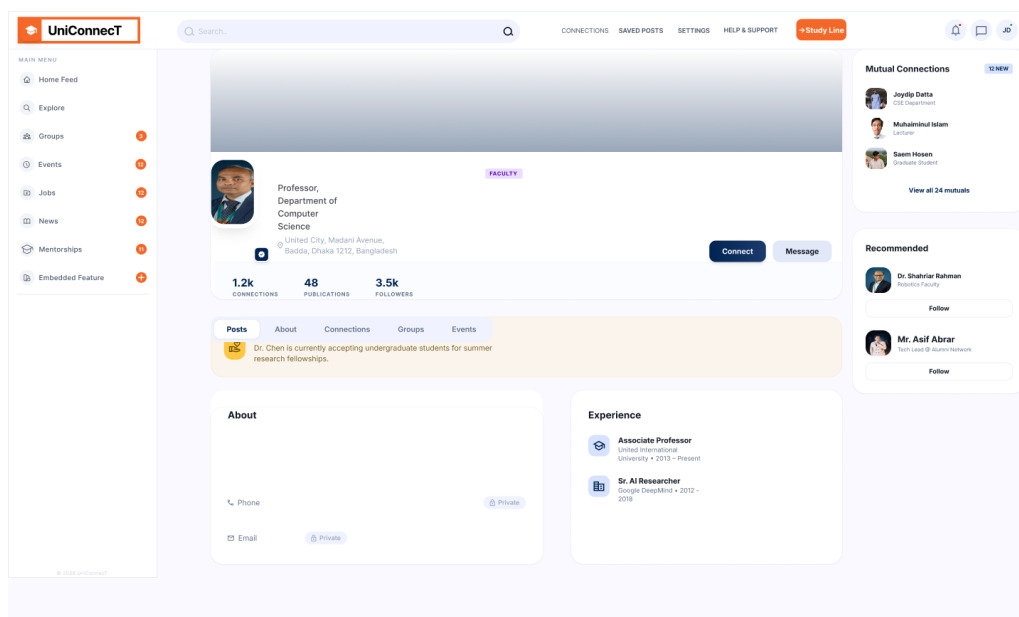


Figure 5: Figma Wireframe — Profile Page. Cover photo, avatar, bio, experience, education, skills, featured items, and profile analytics. Edit controls are visible for the profile owner.

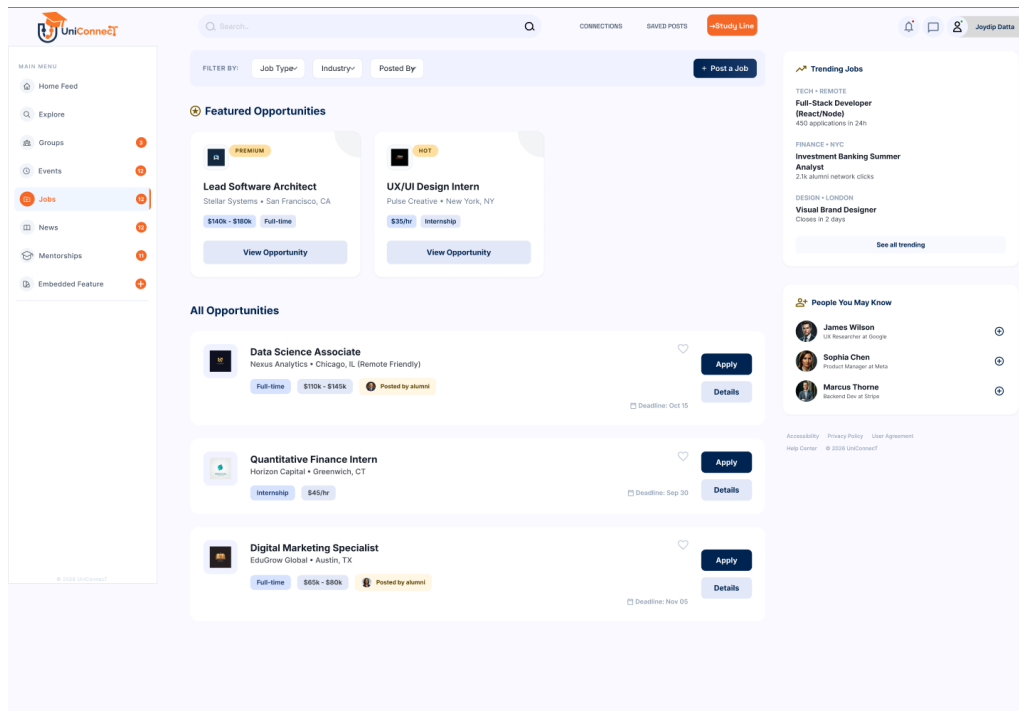


Figure 6: Figma Wireframe — Jobs Page. Filterable and sortable listing of university-internal job and internship postings, with a detail panel for the selected listing.

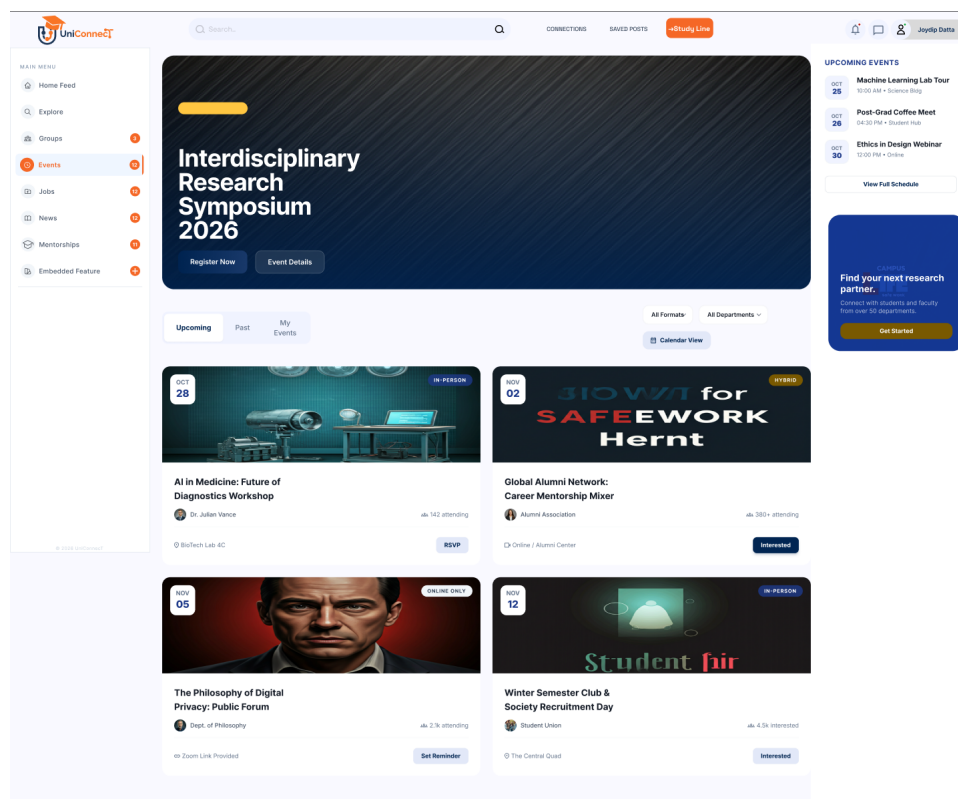


Figure 7: Figma Wireframe — Events Page. Campus event listing with RSVP buttons and a detail view showing event date, location, description, and attendee count.

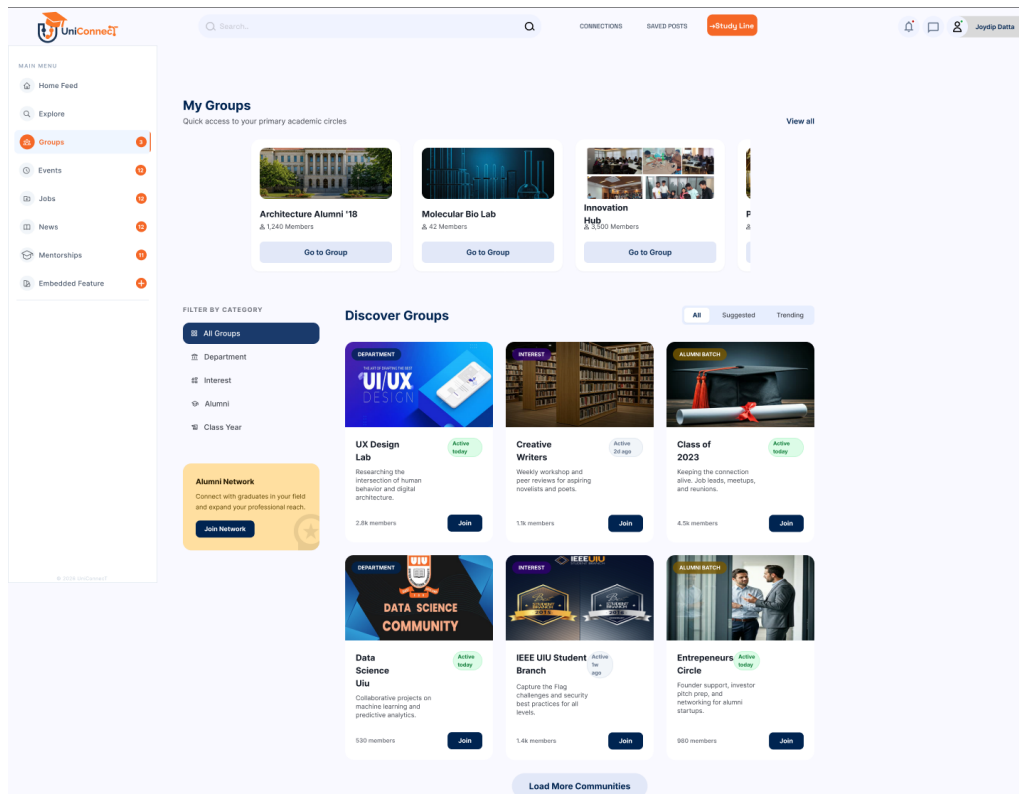


Figure 8: Figma Wireframe — Groups Page. Group directory and a group detail view showing the group feed, members list, file resources, study sessions, pinned posts, and group rules.

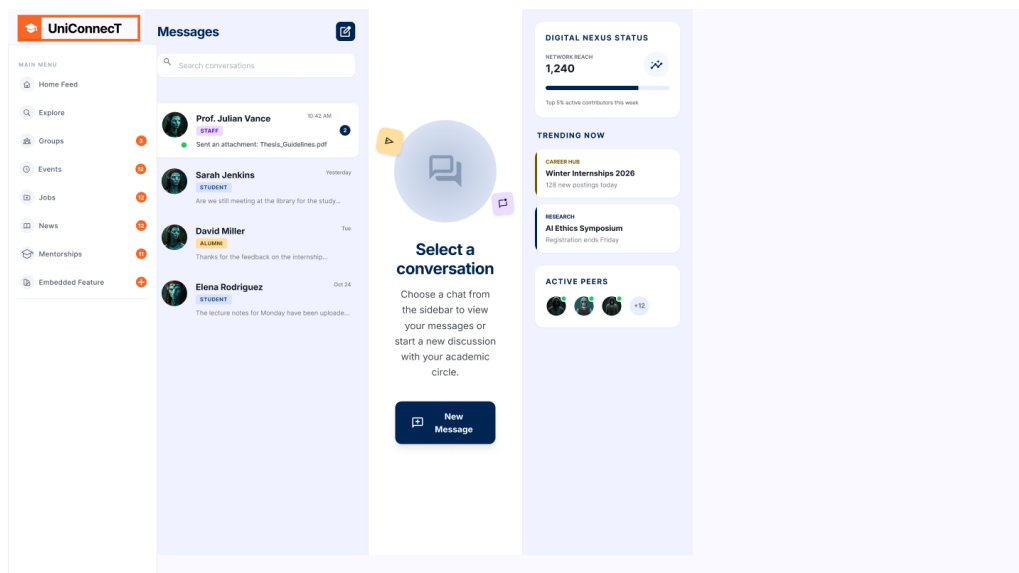


Figure 9: Figma Wireframe — Messages Page. Real-time messaging interface with a conversation list on the left and an active chat panel on the right, supporting direct messages, group chats, and mentorship threads.

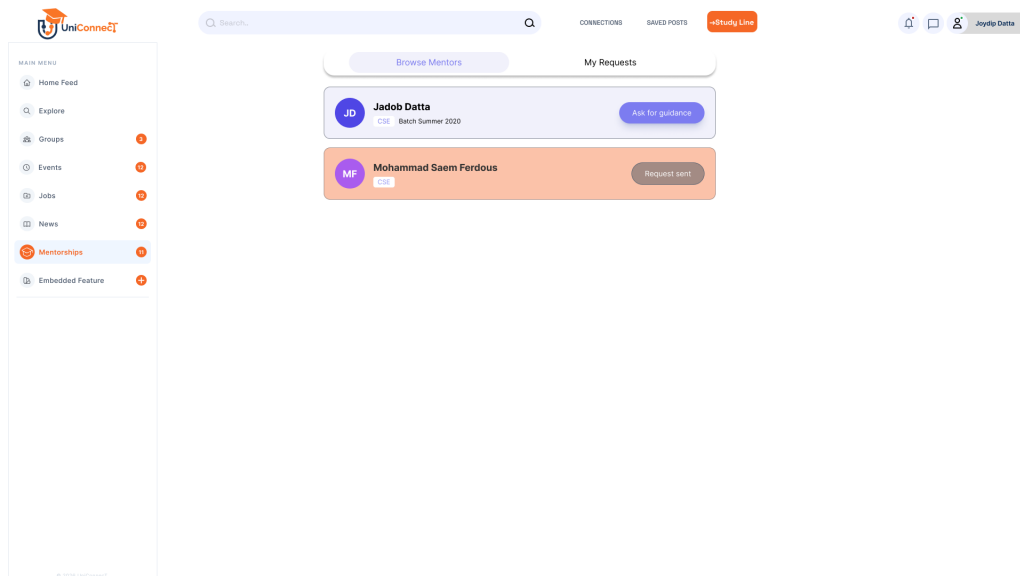


Figure 10: Figma Wireframe — Mentorship Page. Students browse alumni mentor cards and submit requests; alumni manage active mentees, session records, and mentee capacity.

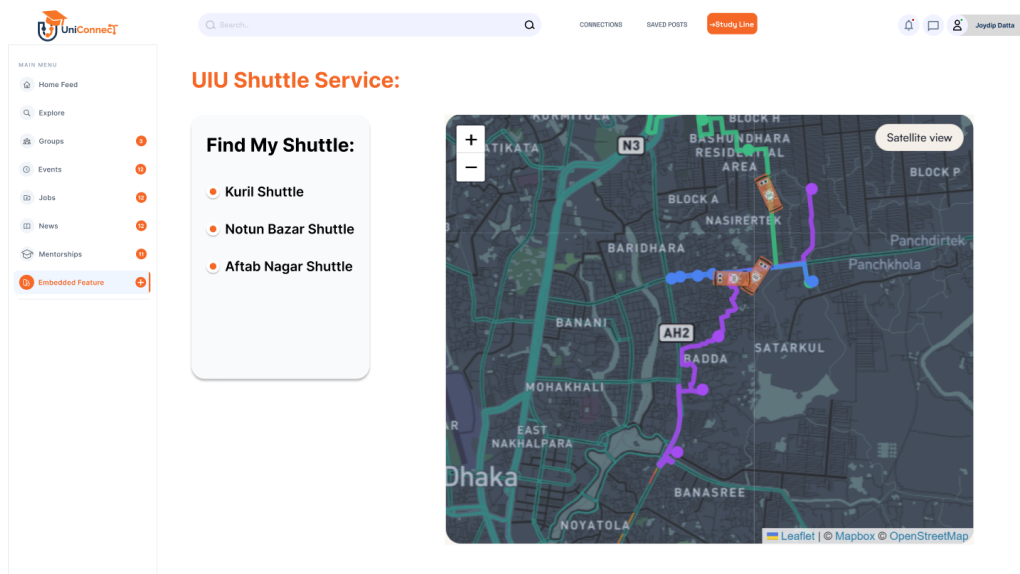


Figure 11: Figma Wireframe — Campus Tools: Lost & Found module (left) for posting and browsing campus item reports, and Shuttle Tracker (right) showing live route and shuttle position.

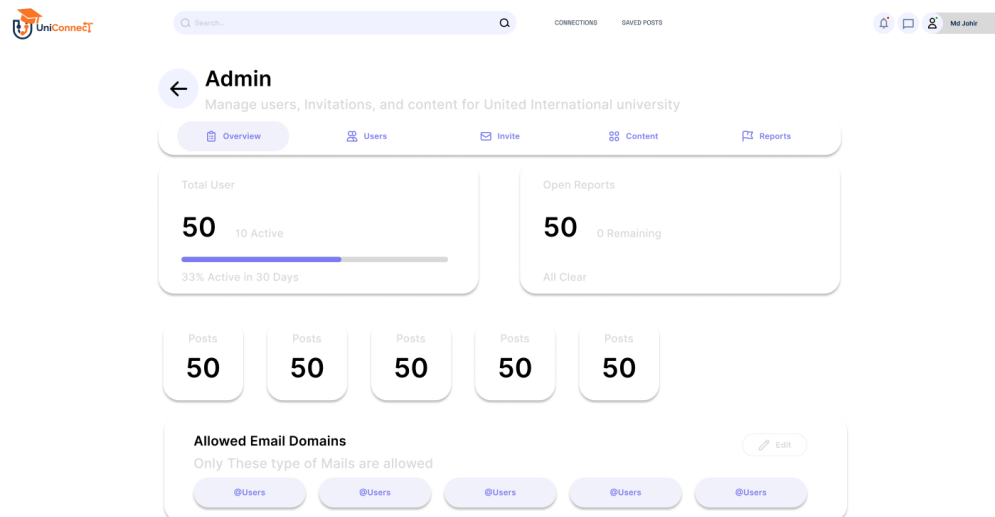


Figure 12: Figma Wireframe — Admin Panel. Role-restricted management interface covering user management, invitation management, content report resolution, platform statistics, and university configuration.

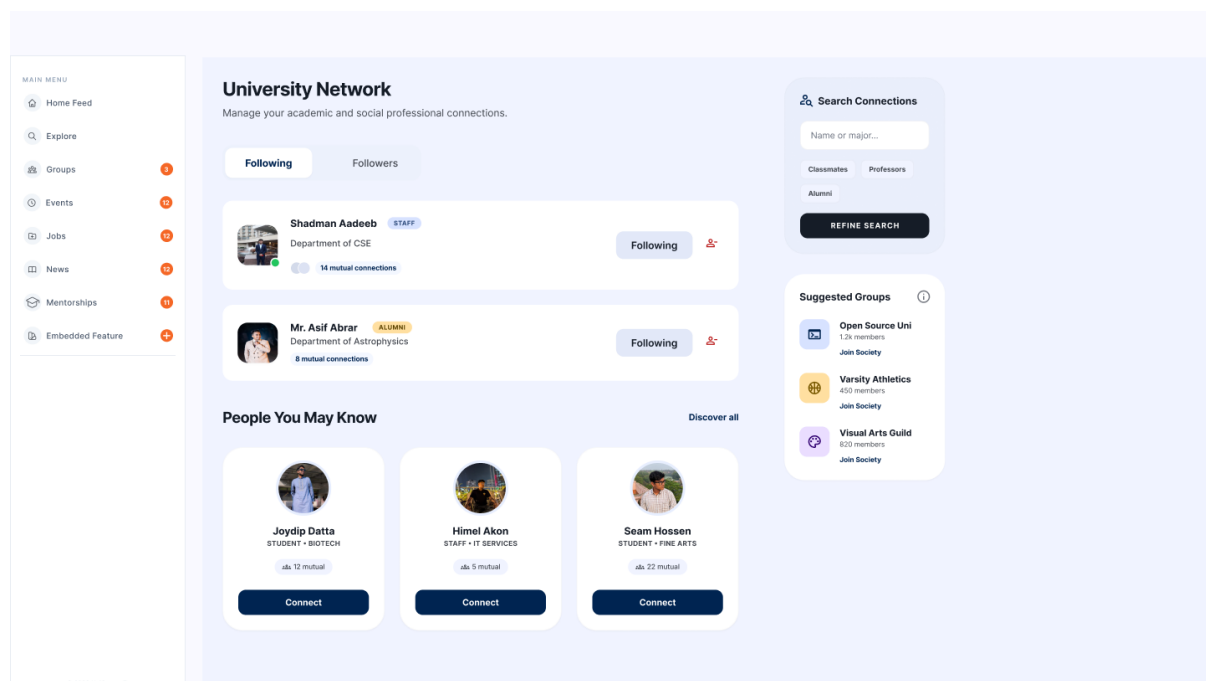


Figure 13: Figma Diagram — Navigation Flow. Full page-to-page user flow for UniConnecT, covering the unauthenticated path (Landing → Login / Register → OTP) and the authenticated paths across all 24 modules, with role-based branching to the Admin Panel and Driver GPS Broadcast View.

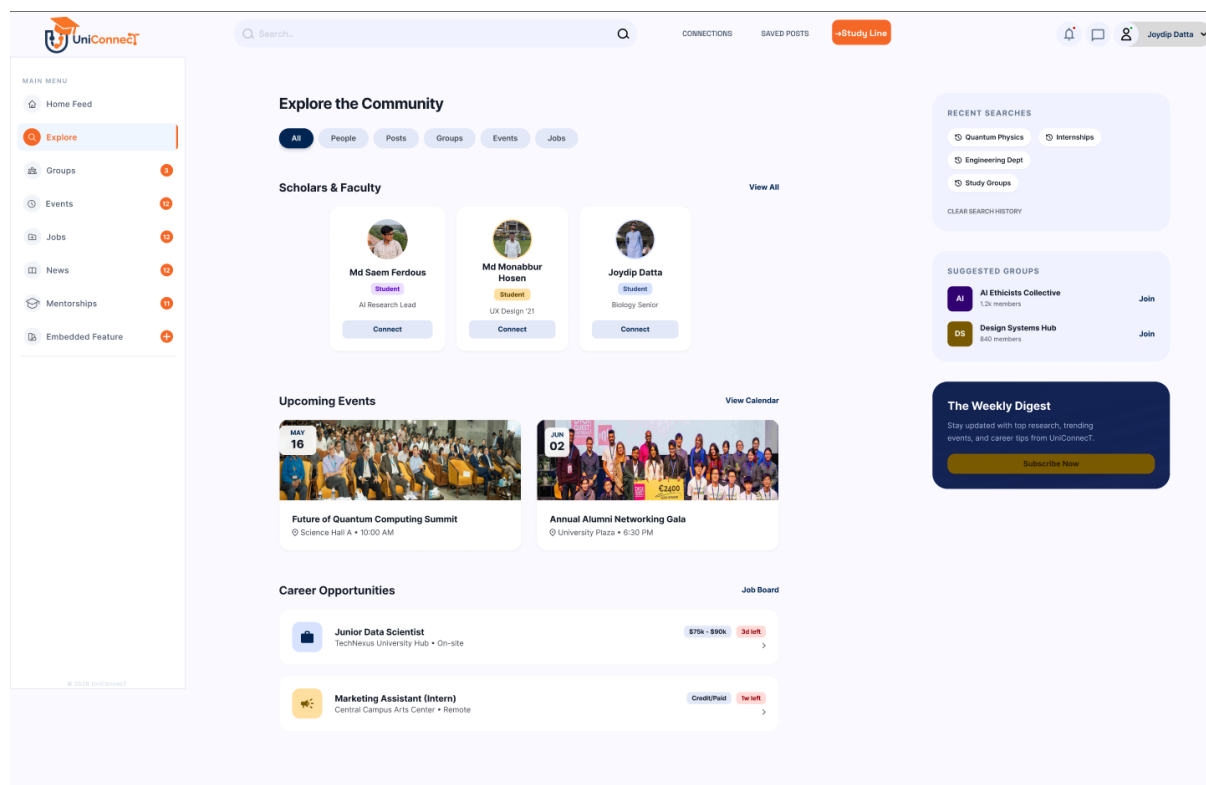


Figure 14: Figma Diagram — Module Architecture. Logical grouping and connections between UniConnecT’s major module clusters: Social (Feed, Profile, Connections, Explore, Search), Professional (Jobs, Events, Mentorship), Community (Groups, News, Messages), Campus Tools (Lost & Found, Shuttle), and Management (Settings, Drafts, Admin Panel).

9. Usability / Design Considerations

9.1 Navigation Flow

UniConnecT uses a persistent top navigation bar on all authenticated pages, providing direct access to the five primary sections: Feed, Jobs, Events, Messages, and Notifications. A left-side profile summary panel on wider screens offers quick links to Profile, Groups, Mentorship, Explore, Lost & Found, Shuttle, and Drafts. The navigation set is role-aware: admin-only controls (Admin Panel) appear only for administrator-role users, and the Driver GPS Broadcast View is exclusive to the driver role. The unauthenticated shell (Landing, Login, Register, OTP, Forgot Password) is entirely separate from the authenticated application and shares no navigation elements with it.

9.2 Responsiveness Across Devices

The design targets three primary breakpoints: mobile (360px–767px), tablet (768px–1023px), and desktop (1024px and above). On mobile, the top navigation bar collapses to a bottom tab bar covering the five primary sections, and the three-column feed layout (feed + two sidebars) reflows to a single-column view. Job and event card grids reflow from three columns on desktop to two on tablet and one on mobile. All interactive touch targets are designed at a minimum of 44×44px on mobile to meet accessibility touch-target guidelines.

9.3 Color Consistency and Design System

UniConnecT is designed with two themes defined in a centralized Figma design system:

- **Warm Futuristic Dark (Default):** Deep navy background surfaces, UIU orange as the primary brand and interactive accent, and indigo for secondary interactive states. Warm white text tokens are used on all dark surfaces. Coloured surfaces (e.g., orange notification badges) use the matching light token for text.
- **Warm Neutral Light:** Off-white and warm grey surfaces with the same UIU orange accent, designed for users who prefer a light interface. Toggled via the user’s theme preference in Settings.

No ad-hoc or hardcoded color values appear anywhere in the design. All fills and strokes reference named Figma color styles. Structural borders are 0.5px. All buttons use pill-shaped (fully rounded) border radii exclusively.

9.4 Accessibility Considerations

- **Color Contrast:** All text-on-background color pairings in both themes meet a minimum 4.5:1 contrast ratio (WCAG 2.1 Level AA), verified using the A11y Figma plugin during the design process.
- **Typography:** Body text is set at 14px minimum. Font weight is restricted to 400 (regular) and 500 (medium) throughout. Section headings establish hierarchy through size differences, not color or weight extremes.
- **Interactive States:** All buttons, links, form fields, navigation items, and cards include clearly visible hover, focus, and active states, ensuring keyboard and screen-reader users can navigate effectively.
- **Labels and Tooltips:** All form inputs carry visible text labels. Icon-only controls (e.g., reaction buttons, share, bookmark) include tooltips to communicate purpose

without relying solely on icon recognition.

- **Empty and Error States:** Every list, feed, and search result view has a designed empty state with a clear message. Every form includes inline error messages positioned adjacent to the failing field rather than at the top of the page only.

9.5 Key User-Friendly Design Decisions

- **Skeleton Loading States:** The feed, profile, jobs, events, and groups pages use skeleton placeholder cards while content loads, ensuring the interface never presents a blank screen and conveys immediate responsiveness.
- **Role-Aware Navigation:** Navigation surfaces adapt automatically based on the logged-in user's role, so students never encounter admin controls and drivers see only their broadcast interface.
- **Progressive Disclosure:** Secondary and advanced actions (post editing options, advanced group settings, mentorship session notes, privacy controls) are revealed via dropdown menus or modals, keeping primary page views uncluttered and focused.
- **Unified Search:** A single persistent search bar in the top navigation queries all content types simultaneously, with tabbed result views for People, Posts, Jobs, Events, Groups, and News — removing the need for users to navigate to individual sections to search within them.
- **Automatic Mentorship Thread:** When a mentorship request is accepted, a dedicated conversation thread is automatically created and surfaced in the Messages module, eliminating the friction of manually initiating contact after acceptance.
- **Drafts Across Content Types:** A unified Drafts page aggregates all of a user's unpublished content (posts, jobs, news, events) in one place, preventing work from being lost across disconnected creation flows.
- **Consistent Component Language:** Cards, modals, input fields, badges, tabs, and buttons follow a single visual specification across all 24 pages of the design, reducing the visual learning curve for new users and ensuring a coherent, professional-quality interface throughout.

10. Conclusion

UniConnecT is a planned private university social networking platform designed to address the fragmentation and absence of a dedicated digital community space for university students, alumni, faculty, and staff. This Software Requirements Specification documents the system's five intended user roles, 29 functional requirements spanning social networking, professional development, mentorship, campus utilities, real-time communication, and administration, 10 non-functional quality requirements, and the full scope of 24 planned pages and modules — all expressed through the UniConnecT Figma design prototype.

The design goals of UniConnecT center on delivering a unified, role-aware, and accessible platform that connects every member of the university community in a single trusted environment. By grounding the design in a coherent UIU-branded design system (Warm Futuristic Dark and Warm Neutral Light themes), a clear multi-role navigation architecture, and established WCAG 2.1 accessibility standards, the planned interface is intended to provide a modern, student-centric experience that meaningfully bridges academic life, professional development, and everyday campus engagement.

This SRS, prepared by Team Mavericks as part of the System Analysis and Design course at United International University (UIU), serves as the foundational specification for the accompanying Figma prototype and guides all design decisions made throughout the project.